

Day 1:

Starting from – C'mon Inn
Mammoth Hot Spring
Norris Geyser
Artist Point Brink os Lower falls
Lookout point
Hayden Valley
Mud volcano
Yellowstone Lake
Tower falls
Lamar valley
End day at – Cabin Village (Island Park)

Day 2:

Start from – Cabin Village (Island Park)
Teton:
 Jackson Lake
 Oxbow Bend
 Snake River Overlook
 Jenny Lake
 Mormon Row
End day at – Cabin Village (Island Park)

Day 3:

Start from – Cabin Village (Island Park)
Grand Prismatic Spring
Old faithful loop
Fountain Paint Pots
West Thumb Geyser Basin
Biscuit Basin
Black Sand Basin
Firehole Lake drive
End day at – Bozeman Airport

Your current itinerary has a lot of backtracking on Day 1, especially mixing Upper Loop + Canyon + Lake + Lamar in an inefficient order. Yellowstone works best when you think in terms of the park's two "figure-8" loops:

- * **Upper Loop** → Mammoth, Norris, Canyon, Tower, Lamar
- * **Lower Loop** → Old Faithful, Grand Prismatic, West Thumb, Hayden, Lake

I reorganized your stops to minimize zig-zag driving while still keeping your hotel locations intact.

Optimized Itinerary

Day 1 – Upper Loop + Canyon (Best wildlife day)

Start: **C'mon Inn, Bozeman**

Recommended Route

1. Mammoth Hot Springs
2. Norris Geyser Basin
3. Artist Point / Brink of Lower Falls / Lookout Point
4. Hayden Valley
5. Mud Volcano
6. Tower Fall
7. Lamar Valley (sunset wildlife viewing)
8. Drive to Island Park

Why this order?

- * You enter Yellowstone from the north, so Mammoth is naturally first.
- * Norris sits directly on the way toward Canyon.
- * Canyon viewpoints are clustered together.
- * Hayden + Mud Volcano are adjacent.
- * Then continue north via Dunraven Pass to Tower and Lamar without backtracking.
- * Lamar is best near sunset for wildlife.

Day 1 Drive Breakdown

Route	Distance	Drive Time
Bozeman → Mammoth Hot Springs	~89 mi	~1 hr 45 min
Mammoth → Norris Geyser Basin	~21 mi	~35 min
Norris → Artist Point/Canyon Area	~12 mi	~30 min
Canyon Area → Hayden Valley	~7 mi	~15 min
Hayden Valley → Mud Volcano	~5 mi	~10 min
Mud Volcano → Tower Fall	~27 mi	~50 min
Tower Fall → Lamar Valley	~18 mi	~30 min
Lamar Valley → Island Park Cabin Village	~105 mi	~2 hr 30 min

Total driving

- * ~284 miles
- * ~7.5–8.5 hrs driving (without sightseeing stops)

This is a long day but efficient.

Day 2 – Grand Teton Day

Your original order is mostly good, but this sequence flows better geographically.

Start: **Cabin Village (Island Park)**

Optimized Route

1. Oxbow Bend *(best morning light)*
2. Jackson Lake
3. Snake River Overlook
4. Jenny Lake
5. Mormon Row *(best near sunset)*
6. Return to Island Park

Day 2 Drive Breakdown

Route	Distance	Drive Time
Island Park → Oxbow Bend	~112 mi	~2 hr 20 min
Oxbow Bend → Jackson Lake	~5 mi	~10 min
Jackson Lake → Snake River Overlook	~12 mi	~20 min
Snow River Overlook → Jenny Lake	~10 mi	~20 min
Jenny Lake → Mormon Row	~17 mi	~30 min
Mormon Row → Island Park	~125 mi	~2 hr 40 min

Total driving

- * ~281 miles
- * ~6.5–7 hrs driving

This is another big day, but very manageable if you leave early.

Day 3 – Lower Loop Geyser Day (Most Efficient)

Your original Day 3 had some backtracking. This version keeps everything in a clean clockwise loop.

Start: **Cabin Village (Island Park)**

End: **Bozeman Airport**

Optimized Route

1. Firehole Lake Drive
2. Fountain Paint Pots
3. Grand Prismatic Spring
4. Old Faithful / Upper Geyser Basin
5. Black Sand Basin

- 6. Biscuit Basin
- 7. West Thumb Geyser Basin
- 8. Drive to Bozeman Airport

Day 3 Drive Breakdown

Route	Distance	Drive Time
Island Park → Firehole Lake Drive	~32 mi	~45 min
Firehole Lake Drive → Fountain Paint Pots	~3 mi	~5 min
Fountain Paint Pots → Grand Prismatic	~5 mi	~10 min
Grand Prismatic → Old Faithful	~7 mi	~15 min
Old Faithful → Black Sand Basin	~1 mi	~5 min
Black Sand Basin → Biscuit Basin	~2 mi	~5 min
Biscuit Basin → West Thumb	~20 mi	~35 min
West Thumb → Bozeman Airport	~190 mi	~4 hr 15 min

Total driving

- * ~260 miles
- * ~6–6.5 hrs driving

Additional Optimization Tips

1. Start EARLY

For Yellowstone, “early” means:

- * Leave by **6:00–6:30 AM**
- * Parking lots fill rapidly after 9 AM.

2. Best wildlife windows

- * Lamar Valley → sunrise/sunset
- * Hayden Valley → early morning

3. Most crowded locations

- * Grand Prismatic
- * Old Faithful
- * Artist Point

Try to hit these before 10 AM or after 4 PM.

4. Important 2026 note

Check Yellowstone road construction before departure. Summer delays can

easily add 30–60 minutes. ([travelbuddylisa.com][1])

5. Your busiest day

Day 1 is the heaviest. If you start feeling rushed:

- * Skip Yellowstone Lake stop (not essential if doing Grand Teton next day)
- * Or shorten Lamar Valley time

Overall Route Logic

Your optimized trip now becomes:

- * **Day 1:** Yellowstone Upper Loop + Canyon + Lamar
- * **Day 2:** Grand Teton
- * **Day 3:** Yellowstone Lower Loop geysers